

## ALLIOLI

### AIOLI

MAKES ABOUT ½ CUP

2 garlic cloves, smashed

Pinch of kosher salt

6 tablespoons vegetable oil

2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil

1 large egg yolk

½ teaspoon red wine vinegar

- 1 Mash the smashed garlic and salt together in a mortar with a pestle until the garlic is completely broken into a fine paste. Combine the oils in a spouted measuring cup.
- 2 Scrape the garlic paste into a medium bowl. Whisk in the egg yolk until the yolk is loose and a bit pale. Whisking constantly, begin adding the blended oil a few drops at a time. Be sure each drop is fully whisked in before adding the next. As the base thickens, you can add oil a bit faster down the side of the bowl in a steady trickle, continuing to whisk constantly. When thickened, begin whisking in the vinegar. The allioli is finished when all the oil and vinegar is whisked in and the mixture is white or pale yellow, shiny, and stands up firm like Greek yogurt. Add a drop or two of water if it is too thick, and season with more salt if needed.
- 3 Spoon the allioli into an airtight container, cover the surface with plastic wrap, and store in the refrigerator for 1 to 2 days.

**EL CONSELL:** Strictly traditional allioli uses about four times as much garlic as this recipe and skips the egg yolk. But I like how the yolk mellows out the garlic a bit and keeps the sauce smooth and creamy.

In a “broken” allioli, the oil will separate out from everything else and the mixture will look lumpy. If this happens, whisk a single egg yolk in a medium bowl until the yolk is pale yellow. Then whisk or blend in the broken allioli in a slow, steady trickle. It will re-emulsify, regaining its smooth texture.

If you’re in a real pinch, you could cheat by mixing the mashed garlic into store-bought mayonnaise.

## ROMESCO

### NUT AND PEPPER SAUCE

MAKES ABOUT 1 CUP

2 dried ñora chiles or 1 ancho chile

1 cup boiling water

⅓ cup skin-on almonds

2 Roma or vine tomatoes

¼ cup plus 2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil

2 slices stale bread, crusts removed

6 garlic cloves, peeled and whole

Kosher salt

Small pinch of crushed red pepper (optional; see note)

1 tablespoon red wine vinegar

- 1 Position one rack 4 to 6 inches from the broiler and another rack in the center of the oven. Preheat the oven to 350°F.
- 2 Place the dried chiles in a small heatproof bowl and pour the boiling water over them. Let stand until the chiles swell significantly and soften, about 15 minutes. Drain. Remove the stems and seeds from the chiles and set the flesh aside.
- 3 Meanwhile, arrange the almonds in a single layer on a sheet pan and bake in the center of the oven until fragrant and toasted, about

10 minutes. Remove from the oven and set aside.

- 4 Turn the oven to broil. Place the tomatoes on a sheet pan and broil until blackened all over, about 5 minutes, turning once or twice. Transfer to a small heatproof bowl and cover with plastic wrap. Let stand until cool enough to handle, about 5 minutes. Remove the skins from the tomatoes and set aside.
- 5 In a medium saucepan, heat ¼ cup of the oil over medium-high heat. When the oil is shimmering, add the bread and toast until it is golden brown and crisp, about 2 minutes. Remove to a plate. Add the garlic to the hot oil and cook, stirring, until the garlic is golden brown, about 3 minutes. Remove the pan from the heat.
- 6 Mash the softened chiles with a pinch of salt in a mortar with a pestle until all the skin is broken down. (You can also do this in a processor, but the color and texture will be slightly different. Add the ingredients in the order specified.) Break the bread into little pieces and add to the mortar or processor, then pound or process the bread to break it apart. Add the almonds, garlic, and pepper flakes and pound or process well after each addition, until the mixture forms a buttery paste. Pound or pulse in the charred tomatoes until smooth, occasionally scooping the corners of the mortar with a spoon or scraping down the sides of the processor bowl to draw in the ingredients. Stir or pulse in the vinegar, remaining 2 tablespoons oil, and a few generous pinches of salt.
- 7 Store in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 1 week. Or spoon the romesco into ice cube trays in 2-tablespoon portions. Pour a thin layer of oil on top

of each cube. Freeze until solid and then transfer the frozen romesco to freezer bags, squeeze out all the air, and seal. Store in the freezer for up to 3 months. Thaw before using or add directly to the pan for dishes that will be simmering.

**EL CONSELL:** Skip the red pepper flakes if you use ancho chiles. The anchos will be spicy enough.

